

Nokia (Infinaera)

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About Nokia:

Infinaera, a leading fiber optics company, was acquired by Nokia in February 2025. Nokia's optical network solutions provide scalable, secure, and reliable connectivity, enabling operators to support new services and applications while simplifying network operations.

The solutions span across network edge, metro, national, long-haul, and subsea deployments, offering smarter and more automated networks with reduced total cost of ownership (TCO). By supporting next-generation services such as 5G, high-speed packet services (400G, 800G, and beyond), and advanced C+L band solutions, Nokia helps customers stay competitive and transform optical networks into value-driven platforms for businesses and end users.

About the role - Software Developer:

- Work within an Agile development environment.
- Develop, test, and document software solutions using languages such as C++ and Python.
- Perform analysis, development, and automation testing of software modules.
- Support integration of optical software with hardware systems.
- Conduct basic data analysis and visualization of performance metrics.
- Participate in code reviews and team discussions to adopt best practices and contribute ideas.

Preparation Strategy:

- **Learn something new every day** – no matter how small. Consistency compounds over time.
- **Focus on DSA** – I primarily used *NeetCode 150*, which I found quicker to complete compared to Striver's sheet (though both are good resources).
- **Strengthen SQL skills** – solving *LeetCode SQL 50* problems was very helpful.

- **Leverage quality content creators** – channels like Fireship, Low Level Learning, The Primeagen, ByteByteGo, and LaurieWired provided concise and practical insights.
- **Stay connected to core subjects** – Operating Systems, DBMS, Computer Networks, and System Design are critical for interviews and real-world problem-solving.
- **Step out of your comfort zone** – don't be afraid to experiment and make mistakes. College life is the best time to explore, fail fast, and learn from those experiences.
- For Aptitude, use Indiabix and careerride. Watch careeride videos at 2X.

Online Round:

The online round was conducted on **DoSelect**. It included:

- **35 MCQs** on core subjects (Networks, OS, DBMS, Python, C++, Java, OOPs)
- **10 Aptitude questions** (relatively easy)
- **1 DSA problem** – I solved it using a brute-force approach, which still passed all the test cases.

Interviews:

The number of interviews varied for different candidates.

Technical Interview 1

This round started with questions from my **self-introduction** and quickly turned into a **resume deep dive**.

- I was asked about **emulators, virtualization, and cloud computing**.
- To **draw ER diagrams** for my projects.
- **Debugging scenario**: "A client calls saying the website is not reachable, how would you approach debugging?"
 - I suggested checking firewall ACLs, using ping and traceroute to examine the topology and hops, and verifying DNS propagation.
- Difference between types of **hypervisors**.
- Several questions were project-specific.

Technical Interview 2 (Virtual)

This round was more advanced, often going beyond what we typically cover in class.

- **Debugging in Linux** – The expected answer was analyzing a **core dump**, which I eventually arrived at.
- **DSA coding task** – Reverse a linked list on an online compiler (screen shared). The interviewer guided me through missed semicolons and later asked me to use **pointers to modify the list directly** rather than assigning a new head.
- **Exception handling in C++** – I mistakenly used a **finally** block (which exists in Java, not C++), but the interviewer was understanding.
- **Diamond problem** – Explained in C++, Python, and Java.
- Further resume-based questions about my projects.
- Behavioral questions:
 - Have you taken up any **leadership roles**? What was your **biggest challenge**?
 - **How do you see yourself in 5 years?**
 - **Why Nokia?**

At the end, when asked if I had any questions, I inquired about **Nokia's sustainability initiatives** and their **research in AI/ML**, which showed my prior research and interest in the company.

Technical Interview 3

This round was very short (around 3 minutes) and felt like a **rapid-fire session**:

- **Postgres** – Why I chose it for my project over other persistence storage options.
- **Nginx** – Why I used it; I explained its role as a reverse proxy and for SSL termination. The interviewer further asked about other use cases, where I discussed **load balancing**.
- **Load balancing algorithms** – Explained the commonly used approaches.
- **Scalability** – How I would scale my project to handle **100,000 monthly active users**.
- **Language preference** – C++ vs. Java, and why I prefer one over the other.

HR Round:

The HR round was more of a formality and casual interaction.

- Questions revolved around my **family background** and my **thoughts about Bangalore**.
- The conversation was light and conversational, with no technical depth.

Final Results:

In the end, around **8 candidates** were selected:

- **4 – Software Developer** (including myself)
- **2 – Software Test**
- **2 – Hardware Developer**

I was offered the role of **Software Developer**.